KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 6: VOICES OF CHANGE · WEEK 27 · READING

The Quiet Clue — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students name the parts of a mystery (puzzle, detective, suspects, clues), tell real clues from red herrings and explain what each clue really shows, recognize an alibi, make inferences from ALL the clues, compare a mystery told by a third-person narrator with one told by a character in the first person, and state the theme two mysteries share as a full sentence about life.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: Savannah, Georgia, was founded in 1733, and 22 of its green squares remain, shaded by live oaks hung with Spanish moss. The student reads two mysteries, one at a bookshop on Wright Square and one beside the fountain in Forsyth Park. The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Week 26 Review (8 pts, 4 each): allusions and myths.
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W27.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: How a Mystery Works. A puzzle, a detective, suspects, clues and red herrings. Model story "The Empty Cookie Jar": the brown smear on Monty's shirt is paint (a red herring); the jar on the top shelf beside Dad's car keys points to Dad. Red herrings are often "loud"; real clues are often "quiet."
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 8 flip cards (mystery, clue, red herring, suspect, alibi, conclusion, draped, startled).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Text A: The Case of the Missing Compass (5 pts). A third-person mystery in six paragraphs: the brass compass prize is missing from Ms. Moira's bookshop on Wright Square, but the glass is not cracked and the lock is still shut. Montrell blames the Spanish moss on the floor and then Mr. Mohan, the man with the huge backpack (his receipt shows six paperbacks). Only Ms. Moira and her nephew Mikael have keys, and the scratch of a pencil leads Mitsuko to Mikael, who borrowed the compass to draw it for the contest poster.
8. Slide 7 — Text B: The Case of the Vanishing Hand Pies (5 pts). Montrell tells this one in the first person: a tray of Grandma Mimi's peach hand pies for the food pantry vanishes near the Forsyth Park fountain. He blames Moxie, Mrs. Mitra's beagle, who is licking her lips, but her leash only reaches halfway (an alibi). Powdered-sugar dots lead to the cooler, where Grandma Mimi moved the pies because the sun was melting the glaze.
9. Slide 8 — Sorting the Clues (10 pts, 5 each): real clue or red herring, and what each clue really shows, across both mysteries.
10. Slide 9 — Teach: Two Mysteries, One Theme. Four steps (puzzle, clues, telling, theme) and a comparison chart. Shared theme: before you blame someone, look at all the evidence, because the most obvious clue can be misleading. Mitsuko shows it by being careful; Montrell learns it the hard way.

11. Slide 10 — Mystery Detective (12 pts, 6 each): the best-supported inference, the shared theme, how the two tellings differ, and catch the mistakes.
12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules. A compound sentence needs a comma before and, and an introductory word or phrase is followed by a comma.
14. Slide 13 — Back It Up With Evidence (4 pts): quote the sentence that proves each point (the quiet clue, why the moss is a red herring, or Moxie's alibi), starting with the tag shown, a comma, and the exact words in quotation marks with the end mark inside. Checked exactly. For the alibi item, the student copies Mrs. Mitra's sentence without her own quotation marks.
15. Slide 14 — Writer's Turn: Explain the Case (6 pts): one typed explanation of the case or the theme auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (allowed names count as one word); and every key idea included. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): mystery words matched to meanings, clues from both stories sorted as real clue, red herring or alibi, or story words matched to meanings (a different set each attempt), 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick mystery questions against the student's own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items across both mysteries (sort the clue, make the inference or name the change, then check the evidence).
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W27.pdf), including the ★ Challenge writing task if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Case Closed!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Master Detective!" with the congratulations message "Master detective! You found every quiet clue!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Keep Going!" with encouragement ("You're getting closer, and every try makes you stronger."), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: WEEK 26 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv1_s0	Set 1: Mosi says, "Spelling tests are my Achilles' heel." What does he mean? [Spelling tests are his one weak spot. / Spelling tests make his feet hurt. / He always gets every spelling word right. / He wants to read a myth about spelling.]	**Spelling tests are his one weak spot.**	An Achilles' heel is one weak spot in someone strong. In the myth, the heel his mother held was the only unprotected spot on Achilles (Week 26).
rv2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: phrases like "the Midas touch" and "Pandora's box" are ___: quick references to well-known stories that readers are expected to recognize.	**allusions** (also accepted: allusion)	A quick reference to a well-known story is an allusion (Week 26).

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv1_s1	Set 2: Which retelling of the Pandora myth is accurate to the oldest telling, by Hesiod? [Pandora lifted the lid of a large jar, troubles flew out, and only hope stayed inside. / Pandora opened a box, and everything flew out, including hope. / Pandora stole fire from the gods and gave it to people. / Pandora wished that everything she touched would turn to gold.]	**Pandora lifted the lid of a large jar, troubles flew out, and only hope stayed inside.**	In Hesiod's telling, the container was a jar and hope stayed inside; Erasmus called it a box in 1508. Stealing fire is Prometheus, and the golden touch is Midas (Week 26).
rv2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: in the Roman poet Ovid's telling, the nymph who could repeat only the last words she heard was named ___.	**echo**	Juno made Echo able to repeat only the last words she heard. That is where our word "echo" comes from (Week 26).
rv1_s2	Set 3: Which sentence uses "opening Pandora's box" CORRECTLY? [Letting one puppy sleep on the bed opened Pandora's box; soon all three puppies wanted to. / Opening Pandora's box, Molly found her birthday present. / Pandora's box means one weak spot in someone strong. / Our coach has Pandora's box, so we win every game.]	**Letting one puppy sleep on the bed opened Pandora's box; soon all three puppies wanted to.**	Opening Pandora's box means starting something that leads to problems no one expected. One puppy on the bed led to all three wanting to (Week 26).
rv2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a traditional story, often about gods or heroes, that explains something about the world is a ___.	**myth** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	A traditional story that explains the world or teaches a lesson is a myth (Week 26).

YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s0	Set 1: From the story: "Live oaks draped in Spanish moss shaded the square." Spanish moss hangs in long gray strands from the branches. What does draped most likely mean? [Hung loosely over something / Cut neatly into squares / Painted a bright color / Planted deep underground]	**Hung loosely over something**	The moss hangs loosely from the branches, so draped means hung loosely over something.
v2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: a clue that seems important but points readers toward the WRONG answer is called a red ___.	**herring** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	A misleading clue is a red herring.
v1_s1	Set 2: From the story: Mitsuko suddenly appears in the doorway, and "Mikael looked up, startled." What does startled most likely mean? [Suddenly surprised / Calm and bored / Fast asleep / Proud and happy]	**Suddenly surprised**	Mikael did not expect anyone to find him, so he is suddenly surprised: startled.
v2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: proof that a suspect was somewhere else, or could not have done it, is called an ___.	**alibi** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	An alibi shows a suspect could not have done it. Mr. Mohan's receipt and Moxie's short leash work like alibis.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s2	Set 3: Which explanation of the difference between a clue and a red herring is correct? [A clue helps lead to the true answer; a red herring seems important but leads to the wrong answer. / A clue and a red herring are exactly the same thing. / A red herring is always a kind of fish in the story. / A clue is always the most exciting detail in the story.]	**A clue helps lead to the true answer; a red herring seems important but leads to the wrong answer.**	Both are details in the story, but only real clues lead to the truth. Red herrings are planted to mislead, and they are often the most exciting details.
v2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a character who might be responsible for the problem in a mystery is a ___.	**suspect** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	A character who might have done it is a suspect.

TEXT A: MYSTERY 1 (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: in paragraph 2, what object is missing from the glass case?	**compass** (also accepted: brass compass; with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Paragraph 2 says "The brass compass that was the prize for the shop's summer reading contest was gone from its glass case."
sa_s1	Set 2: In paragraph 2, Mitsuko notices that "The glass was not cracked, and the little lock was still clicked shut." What can you INFER from this clue? [Whoever took the compass probably opened the case with a key. / A thief smashed the glass to grab the compass. / The compass was never in the case at all. / The lock is broken and cannot be opened.]	**Whoever took the compass probably opened the case with a key.**	If the glass is not broken and the case is locked again, someone opened it with a key. That narrows the suspects to the people who have keys.
sa_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: in paragraph 5, Ms. Moira says only two people have a key to the case: herself and her nephew. Type the nephew's name.	**mikael**	Paragraph 5: "Only me," said Ms. Moira, "and my nephew, Mikael."

TEXT B: MYSTERY 2 (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sb_s0	Set 1: In paragraph 2, Moxie is "licking her lips." Why is this a RED HERRING? [It makes Moxie look guilty, but she was licking her lips because she had just eaten a dog biscuit. / It proves that Moxie ate every pie. / It shows that Grandma Mimi is hungry. / It is the clue that leads Montrell to the cooler.]	**It makes Moxie look guilty, but she was licking her lips because she had just eaten a dog biscuit.**	Licking her lips points toward Moxie, but paragraph 5 explains it: "Mrs. Mitra had just given her a dog biscuit." The clue points the wrong way.
sb_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: in paragraph 4, a line of white dots runs across the grass to the cooler. What are the dots made of? Type the two-word answer.	**powdered sugar** (also accepted: powdered-sugar, sugar)	Paragraph 4 describes "a line of white powdered-sugar dots running across the grass from our table to the cooler."
sb_s2	Set 3: In paragraph 3, Mrs. Mitra says Moxie's "leash only reaches halfway to your table." What does this clue work as? [An alibi: it shows Moxie could not have reached the pies. / A red herring: it makes Moxie look guilty. / A motive: it explains why Moxie wanted pies. / A theme: it is the lesson of the story.]	**An alibi: it shows Moxie could not have reached the pies.**	Proof that a suspect could not have done it is an alibi. A dog that cannot reach the table could not have taken the tray.

SORTING THE CLUES (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp1_s0	Set 1: Is the tall man with the huge backpack in paragraph 4 a real clue or a red herring, and why? [A red herring: his receipt shows he bought six books, and he hurries every Saturday to catch the bus. / A real clue: his backpack proves he took the compass. / A real clue: tall people always have keys. / A red herring: he is the one who drew the poster.]	**A red herring: his receipt shows he bought six books, and he hurries every Saturday to catch the bus.**	He looks suspicious, but Ms. Moira explains why he hurries, and the receipt shows what was in his bag. His story points the wrong way.
qp2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: two steps. The case was opened with a key, and only two people have keys. One is Ms. Moira. Who opened the shop that morning? Type the name.	**mikael**	Paragraph 5: Ms. Moira says Mikael "opened the shop this morning," so he had the key and the chance.
qp1_s1	Set 2: In paragraph 3, Montrell says the Spanish moss under the case means "The thief must have come in from the square." Which explanation shows why this is a red herring? [Moss blows in every time the door opens, and Mitsuko had already swept up three piles that morning. / Spanish moss only grows inside bookshops. / The moss proves the thief climbed a live oak. / Ms. Moira put the moss there as a joke.]	**Moss blows in every time the door opens, and Mitsuko had already swept up three piles that morning.**	Paragraph 3 says "Every time it opened, the breeze blew bits of moss across the floor." The moss would be there no matter what, so it does not point to a thief.
qp2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: two steps. In paragraph 5, Mitsuko hears a sound from the back room that leads her to Mikael. It is the scratch of a ___.	**pencil** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Paragraph 5: "From the back room came the scratch of a pencil." Someone was drawing, which leads Mitsuko to the poster.
qp1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Mirela says, "In Text B, the sugar dots are a red herring, because sugar has nothing to do with pies." Which explanation is correct? [The sugar dots are a real clue: they lead from the table to the cooler, where the missing tray is. / Mirela is right; the dots point the wrong way. / The dots are a red herring because Moxie made them. / The dots are Grandma Mimi's alibi.]	**The sugar dots are a real clue: they lead from the table to the cooler, where the missing tray is.**	A real clue points to the truth. The powdered-sugar trail leads straight to the cooler, where Montrell finds every pie.
qp2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: two steps. Paragraph 5 of Text B explains who moved the pies. Grandma Mimi moved them because the sun was melting the ___.	**glaze** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Grandma Mimi says, "That sun was melting the glaze," so she moved the tray into the shaded cooler.

MYSTERY DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s0	Set 1: Text A, paragraph 6: "Montrell's face turned pink. 'I was sure it was the man with the backpack,' he admitted." Which inference is BEST supported? [Montrell feels embarrassed that he blamed the wrong person. / Montrell is sunburned from the square. / Montrell still thinks Mr. Mohan took the compass. / Montrell is angry at Mitsuko.]	**Montrell feels embarrassed that he blamed the wrong person.**	A face turning pink plus the word "admitted" shows he is embarrassed about his mistake. Nothing supports the other choices.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d2_s0	Set 1: Which theme do BOTH mysteries share? [Before blaming someone, look at all the evidence, because the most obvious clue can mislead you. / Dogs should always be kept on leashes. / Bookshops are the best places to visit in Savannah. / Never borrow anything without asking.]	**Before blaming someone, look at all the evidence, because the most obvious clue can mislead you.**	In both stories, the first suspect is innocent and a quiet clue reveals the truth. The other choices are rules or opinions that fit only one story or neither.
d1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation of how the two mysteries are told DIFFERENTLY is correct? [Text A uses a third-person narrator; Text B is told in the first person by Montrell, so we hear his thoughts and his apology. / Both are told by Mitsuko. / Text A is in the first person, and Text B is in the third person. / Neither story has a narrator.]	**Text A uses a third-person narrator; Text B is told in the first person by Montrell, so we hear his thoughts and his apology.**	Text A uses names and “she” for Mitsuko. Text B uses “I”: “I thought I had learned my lesson at the bookshop.”
d2_s1	Set 2: Text B begins, “I thought I had learned my lesson at the bookshop. I was wrong.” What can you INFER from these sentences? [Montrell is about to make the same kind of mistake again, blaming someone too fast. / Montrell was wrong about which bookshop he visited. / Montrell never went to the bookshop. / Montrell will solve this mystery without any mistakes.]	**Montrell is about to make the same kind of mistake again, blaming someone too fast.**	The lesson from the bookshop was to look at all the clues. “I was wrong” hints that he will jump to a conclusion again, and he does when he blames Moxie.
d1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Monty says, “Mikael is a thief, because he took the compass.” Which explanation is correct? [Monty ignores the evidence: Mikael borrowed it to draw it for the contest poster and meant to put it back. / Monty is right; Mikael sold the compass. / Monty is wrong because Mr. Mohan took it. / Monty is wrong because the compass was never missing.]	**Monty ignores the evidence: Mikael borrowed it to draw it for the contest poster and meant to put it back.**	Paragraph 6: “I borrowed it so I could draw it for the poster … I meant to put it back.” Mikael made a mistake by not asking, but he was not stealing.
d2_s2	Set 3: In Text A, Mitsuko says, “The lock was the quiet one.” Which clue in Text B plays the same role as the lock? [The line of powdered-sugar dots leading to the cooler / Moxie licking her lips / Montrell shouting, “Moxie ate them!” / The big white fountain in Forsyth Park]	**The line of powdered-sugar dots leading to the cooler**	The lock is the small, easy-to-miss detail that solves Text A. In Text B, the quiet clue that solves it is the sugar trail. Moxie licking her lips is the loud red herring.

FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs1_s0	Set 1: Dialogue punctuation: add the missing comma. "Someone stole it" Ms. Moira cried.	**"Someone stole it," Ms. Moira cried.**	When the speaker tag comes after the spoken words, a comma goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s0	Set 1: Capital letters: fix the capital-letter mistakes in the three place names. The bookshop faced wright square in savannah, georgia.	**The bookshop faced Wright Square in Savannah, Georgia.**	Names of specific places are proper nouns, so capitalize every important word: Wright Square, Savannah, Georgia.
fs3_s0	Set 1: Compound sentence: add the comma before the joining word “and.” From the back room came the scratch of a pencil and Mitsuko tiptoed closer.	**From the back room came the scratch of a pencil, and Mitsuko tiptoed closer.**	When “and” joins two complete sentences, put a comma before it.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs4_s0	Set 1: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. The clues in the story points to Mikael.	**The clues in the story point to Mikael.**	The subject is “clues” (plural), not “story,” so the verb is “point.”
fs1_s1	Set 2: Commas in a series: add the commas between the three clues. Mitsuko studied the moss the lock and the receipt.	**Mitsuko studied the moss, the lock, and the receipt.** (also accepted: Mitsuko studied the moss, the lock and the receipt.)	Use commas to separate three items in a series: the moss, the lock, and the receipt.
fs2_s1	Set 2: Dialogue capitalization: fix the capital-letter mistake. Mitsuko asked, "who has a key to the case?"	**Mitsuko asked, "Who has a key to the case?"**	The first word of a quoted sentence is capitalized, even in the middle of your sentence.
fs3_s1	Set 2: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. Suddenly Montrell noticed the sugar dots.	**Suddenly, Montrell noticed the sugar dots.**	Put a comma after an introductory word like “Suddenly.”
fs4_s1	Set 2: Grammar: fix the its / it’s mistake. The beagle wagged it's tail.	**The beagle wagged its tail.**	“It’s” means “it is.” The tail belongs to the beagle, so use the possessive “its” with no apostrophe.
fs1_s2	Set 3: Title punctuation: put quotation marks around the story’s title. In The Case of the Missing Compass, the lock is the key clue.	**In "The Case of the Missing Compass," the lock is the key clue.**	The title of a story goes inside quotation marks, and the comma after the title goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s2	Set 3: Dialogue punctuation: move the exclamation point to the right spot. "Moxie ate them"! I shouted.	**"Moxie ate them!" I shouted.**	The exclamation point belongs to the words Montrell shouted, so it goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs3_s2	Set 3: Comma after an introductory phrase: add the missing comma. On Sunday morning Grandma Mimi set up a table.	**On Sunday morning, Grandma Mimi set up a table.**	Put a comma after an introductory phrase like “On Sunday morning.”
fs4_s2	Set 3: Grammar: fix the their / there / they’re mistake. The detectives checked there notes twice.	**The detectives checked their notes twice.**	The notes belong to the detectives, so use the possessive “their,” not “there.”

BACK IT UP WITH EVIDENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s0	Set 1: This sentence is the quiet clue that shows the case was opened with a key. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 2): The glass was not cracked, and the little lock was still clicked shut. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "The glass was not cracked, and the little lock was still clicked shut."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and the comma before “and” inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s1	Set 2: This sentence shows why the Spanish moss is a red herring. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 3): Every time it opened, the breeze blew bits of moss across the floor. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "Every time it opened, the breeze blew bits of moss across the floor."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and the comma after “opened” inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s2	Set 3: This sentence gives Moxie's alibi. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. (Copy the sentence without Mrs. Mitra's quotation marks.) Original (Text B, paragraph 3): Her leash only reaches halfway to your table. Start with: Mrs. Mitra says	**Mrs. Mitra says, "Her leash only reaches halfway to your table."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

WRITER'S TURN: EXPLAIN THE CASE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s0	Set 1: In one or two sentences, explain HOW Mitsuko solves the mystery: which quiet clue she follows and where it leads her. Text A, paragraphs 2, 5, and 6: This Saturday, something was wrong. The brass compass that was the prize for the shop's summer reading contest was gone from its glass case. "Someone stole it!" Ms. Moira cried. Mitsuko leaned close to the case. The glass was not cracked, and the little lock was still clicked shut. ... Mitsuko thought about the lock. "Who has a key to the case?" she asked. "Only me," said Ms. Moira, "and my nephew, Mikael. He opened the shop this morning." From the back room came the scratch of a pencil. Mitsuko tiptoed to the doorway. Mikael was bent over a big poster for the reading contest, sketching a circle with a pointed needle inside it. ... Beside his elbow, half buried under sheets of poster paper, lay the brass compass. Mikael looked up, startled. "I borrowed it so I could draw it for the poster," he said. "I meant to put it back before anyone noticed." Ms. Moira laughed with relief. Montrell's face turned pink. "I was sure it was the man with the backpack," he admitted. Mitsuko smiled. "The backpack was the loudest clue. The lock was the quiet one." Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the story. (Names like Mitsuko and Mikael are fine.) Name the detective: include Mitsuko (or she). Name the quiet clue: the locked case or the key. Name who had the key: Mikael, the nephew. Tell where it leads: the pencil sound or the poster in the back room. Original: "This Saturday, something was wrong. The brass compass that was the prize for the shop's summer reading contest was gone from its glass case. Someone stole it! Ms. Moira cried. Mitsuko leaned close to the case. The glass was not cracked, ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** Mitsuko realizes the unbroken, locked case means someone used a key, and when she hears drawing in the back room, she finds Mikael with the compass beside his poster.	A strong answer names Mitsuko, the quiet clue (the locked, unbroken case means a key was used), the key holder Mikael, and the pencil sound or poster that leads her to him, in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: mitsuko or she; lock or key or crack or broken or unbroken or glass; mikael or nephew; pencil or back room or poster or draw or sketch or scratch.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s1	Set 2: In one or two sentences, explain why Moxie licking her lips is a RED HERRING in Text B, and give the evidence that clears her. Text B, paragraphs 2, 3, and 5: On Sunday, Grandma Mimi set up a table near the big white fountain in Forsyth Park to sell peach hand pies for the neighborhood food pantry. When I came back from filling our water jug, one whole tray of pies was gone. Under the next table sat Moxie, Mrs. Mitra's beagle, licking her lips. ... "Moxie ate them!" I shouted. Mrs. Mitra, who was selling honey at the next table, looked hurt. "Montrell, Moxie has been tied to my chair all morning," she said. "Her leash only reaches halfway to your table." ... "Oh, I moved those," Grandma Mimi said, walking up with a stack of napkins. "That sun was melting the glaze." And Moxie? Mrs. Mitra had just given her a dog biscuit. Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the story. (Names like Moxie and Mrs. Mitra are fine.) Name the suspect: include Moxie (or the dog). Tell why she looks guilty: she is licking her lips. Give evidence that clears her: the biscuit or the short leash. Tell the truth: Grandma Mimi moved the pies to the cooler. Original: "On Sunday, Grandma Mimi set up a table near the big white fountain in Forsyth Park to sell peach hand pies for the neighborhood food pantry. When I came back from filling our water jug, one whole tray of pies was gone. Under the next table ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** Moxie looks guilty because she keeps licking her lips, but she had just eaten a biscuit, her leash is too short, and Grandma Mimi had carried the pies to the cooler.	A strong answer names Moxie, explains why she seems guilty (licking her lips), gives the evidence that clears her (a biscuit, a short leash), and tells the truth (Grandma Mimi moved the pies), in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: moxie or dog or beagle; lick or lips or guilty or blame or look or seem; biscuit or treat or snack or leash or tied or reach; grandma or mimi or cooler or moved or shade or sugar.
wt_s2	Set 3: In one or two sentences, state the THEME that BOTH mysteries teach as a full sentence about life, then tell how each story shows it. Think about: whom Montrell blames in each story, what the quiet clue turns out to be, and what he says at the end of Text B: "Next time, I am going to look for the quiet clues first." Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from either story. State the lesson: mention evidence or clues. Tell what not to do: do not blame, judge, or jump to conclusions too fast. Show Text A: mention the backpack man, the lock, or Mikael. Show Text B: mention Moxie, the pies, or the sugar trail. Original: "Every Saturday, Mitsuko helped out at Ms. Moira's bookshop, which faced Wright Square in Savannah, Georgia. Live oaks draped in Spanish moss shaded the square, and Ms. Moira liked to remind visitors that Tomochichi, a Creek leader who ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here)	**Sample:** Check all the evidence before you blame anyone, since Montrell wrongly suspects the backpack man in the bookshop and later accuses Moxie, though quiet clues reveal the truth both times.	A strong answer states the theme as a full sentence about life (check all the evidence before blaming someone) and shows it in both stories (the backpack man and Moxie were wrongly suspected), in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: evidence or clue or fact or detail or proof; blam or accus or judg or conclusion or jump or assum or guess or suspect; backpack or man or mohan or compass or lock or bookshop or mikael or mitsuko; moxie or dog or beagle or pie or sugar or cooler or grandma.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match clue	**a detail that helps solve a mystery**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match red herring	**a clue that points the wrong way**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match suspect	**someone who might have done it**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match alibi	**proof a suspect could not have done it**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match conclusion	**a decision based on all the evidence**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match Spanish moss on the floor	**red herring: the breeze blows it in**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match locked, uncracked case	**real clue: someone used a key**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match backpack and a hurry	**red herring: he runs for the bus**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match scratch of a pencil	**real clue: someone is drawing**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match Moxie's short leash	**alibi: she cannot reach the table**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match draped	**hung loosely over something**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match startled	**suddenly surprised**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match admitted	**said something true but embarrassing**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match receipt	**a paper showing what was bought**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match mystery	**a story about a puzzle to solve**	2 points if matched on the first try.

BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, name the RED HERRING in Text A that Montrell believes longest. Step 2, choose the evidence that proves it is a red herring. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Red herring: the man with the backpack. Evidence: his receipt shows six paperbacks, paid in full. / Red herring: the man with the backpack. Evidence: the little lock was still clicked shut. / Red herring: the locked case. Evidence: his receipt shows six paperbacks, paid in full. / Red herring: the pencil sound. Evidence: Mikael opened the shop.]	**Red herring: the man with the backpack. Evidence: his receipt shows six paperbacks, paid in full.**	Montrell is "sure it was the man with the backpack." The receipt explains the bag. The lock is a real clue, not a red herring, and it does not explain the backpack.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b2_s0	Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, choose the theme both stories share. Step 2, choose evidence for it from TEXT B. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Theme: Look at all the evidence before blaming someone. Evidence: “Next time, I am going to look for the quiet clues first.” / Theme: Look at all the evidence before blaming someone. Evidence: “The backpack was the loudest clue.” / Theme: Pies taste best in the shade. Evidence: “That sun was melting the glaze.” / Theme: Dogs always cause trouble. Evidence: “Moxie ate them!”]	**Theme: Look at all the evidence before blaming someone. Evidence: “Next time, I am going to look for the quiet clues first.”**	Montrell’s last line in Text B states what he learned. “The backpack was the loudest clue” supports the theme but comes from Text A. The other themes are not what either story teaches.
b1_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Step 1, how does Montrell change from Text A to the end of Text B? Step 2, which evidence shows it? [He goes from blaming suspects quickly to promising to look for quiet clues first; he apologizes and says, “Next time, I am going to look for the quiet clues first.” / He goes from careful to careless; he solves both cases alone. / He never changes; he blames the backpack man again in Text B. / He goes from shy to bossy; he orders Grandma Mimi to move the pies.]	**He goes from blaming suspects quickly to promising to look for quiet clues first; he apologizes and says, “Next time, I am going to look for the quiet clues first.”**	In both stories he blames too fast, but at the end of Text B he says sorry and states a new plan. That shows a real change.
b2_s1	Set 2: Which NEW mystery uses a red herring the SAME way both of today’s mysteries do? [A class blames the new student for a missing marker because he was standing by the desk, but the marker had rolled under the teacher’s chair. / A girl loses her shoe and finds it in her closet the next day. / A detective solves a case by reading a signed confession. / Two friends argue about which movie to watch.]	**A class blames the new student for a missing marker because he was standing by the desk, but the marker had rolled under the teacher’s chair.**	Like the backpack man and Moxie, the new student is suspected because of a loud detail, and a quiet clue (the chair) shows the truth. The other stories have no red herring.
b1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Molly writes, “Both mysteries are solved by the same character, Mitsuko.” Which explanation is correct? [Mitsuko solves Text A, but Montrell solves Text B himself by following the sugar trail. / Molly is right; Mitsuko solves both. / Grandma Mimi solves Text A. / Neither mystery is ever solved.]	**Mitsuko solves Text A, but Montrell solves Text B himself by following the sugar trail.**	Mitsuko is not in Text B. Montrell notices the sugar dots and finds the tray in the cooler (paragraph 4).
b2_s2	Set 3: Two-step: in Text A, Mikael “meant to put it back before anyone noticed.” Step 1, what can you infer about Mikael? Step 2, what is the best evidence? [He was careless, not dishonest; evidence: he borrowed it to draw it for the contest poster. / He wanted to keep the compass; evidence: it was half buried under poster paper. / He was trying to trick Montrell; evidence: Montrell’s face turned pink. / He did not know where the compass was; evidence: he was sketching a circle.]	**He was careless, not dishonest; evidence: he borrowed it to draw it for the contest poster.**	Mikael explains he borrowed it for the poster and meant to return it. Being under the paper shows it got lost in his work, not that he hid it on purpose.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W27.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: “Fractions are my Achilles’ heel.” Meaning and myth	Mitsuko means fractions are her one weak spot. In the myth, the great warrior Achilles was dipped in the River Styx, but the heel his mother held stayed unprotected.
2	A mystery book, show or movie: the puzzle and who solved it	Answers vary. Check for a title, the puzzle, and the person who solved it.
3	The open window, the empty goldfish bowl and the cat on the sill	The cat looked guilty. The truth: the fish was safe in the kitchen sink while Mom cleaned the bowl.
4	A red herring is most likely a clue that...	points the wrong way
5	Why look at ALL the clues before naming a suspect?	Model: The most obvious clue might be a red herring. Checking every clue makes sure the answer fits all the evidence before you blame someone.

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Ms. Moira’s missing reading glasses	Red herring: the ink on Mikael’s fingers. Real clue: the shiny frame peeking out of Ms. Moira’s hair. Conclusion: the glasses were on Ms. Moira’s head all along.
2	Which clue does Mitsuko call quiet, and how does it narrow the suspects?	The lock: the glass was not cracked and the lock was still clicked shut, so someone opened the case with a key. Only Ms. Moira and her nephew Mikael have keys.
3	Monty: “In both mysteries, the first suspect is guilty.”	Model: In both mysteries, the first suspect is innocent. In Text A, Mr. Mohan’s receipt shows six paperbacks, paid in full, and he hurries every Saturday to catch the bus. In Text B, Moxie’s leash only reaches halfway to the table.
4	Be the editor	a) "Moxie is innocent," Mrs. Mitra said. b) The pies were in the cooler.

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	The opening of a short Savannah mystery with one red herring and one quiet clue	Answers vary. Grading note: 3 or 4 sentences set in Savannah, Georgia; a loud clue that points the wrong way and a small, quiet clue that points to the truth; correct capitals and quotation marks.